CCSA Lab 2: Administrator Account Management

CCSA R82

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Part 1: Hands-On Lab Tasks

Task 1: Modify the Default Admin

Actions Performed

- Opened SmartConsole.
- Navigated to Manage & Settings > Permissions & Administrators > Administrators.
- Modified the cpadmin account.
- Set Color to Pink.
- Added Comment: Default Check Point Administrator.
- Set Expiration to Never.

Observation
The cpadmin account was successfully modified and displayed with a pink icon in the Administrators list.

Task 2: Create a Personal Super User

Actions Performed

- Created a new administrator account.
- Assigned the Super User permission profile.
- Configured Check Point Password authentication.

Observation
The personal administrator account was successfully created and appeared in the Administrators list with the Super User profile**.**

Task 3: Create an Auditor Account

Actions Performed

- Created the Auditor administrator account.
- Assigned the Read Only All permission profile.
- Configured password authentication.

Observation
The Auditor account was successfully created and displayed the Read Only All permission profile.

Task 4: Create a Custom Profile and IPS Administrator

Part A: IPS Only Permission Profile

Actions Performed

- Created a new permission profile named IPS Only.
- Selected Customized permissions.
- Disabled unnecessary Management and Endpoint permissions**.**

Observation
The IPS Only profile was successfully created and appeared in the Permission Profiles list**.**

Part B: IPS Administrator

Actions Performed

- Created an administrator named IPS Administrator.
- Assigned the IPS Only permission profile.

Observation
The IPS Administrator account was successfully created and assigned the IPS Only profile.

Task 5: Publish and Install Database

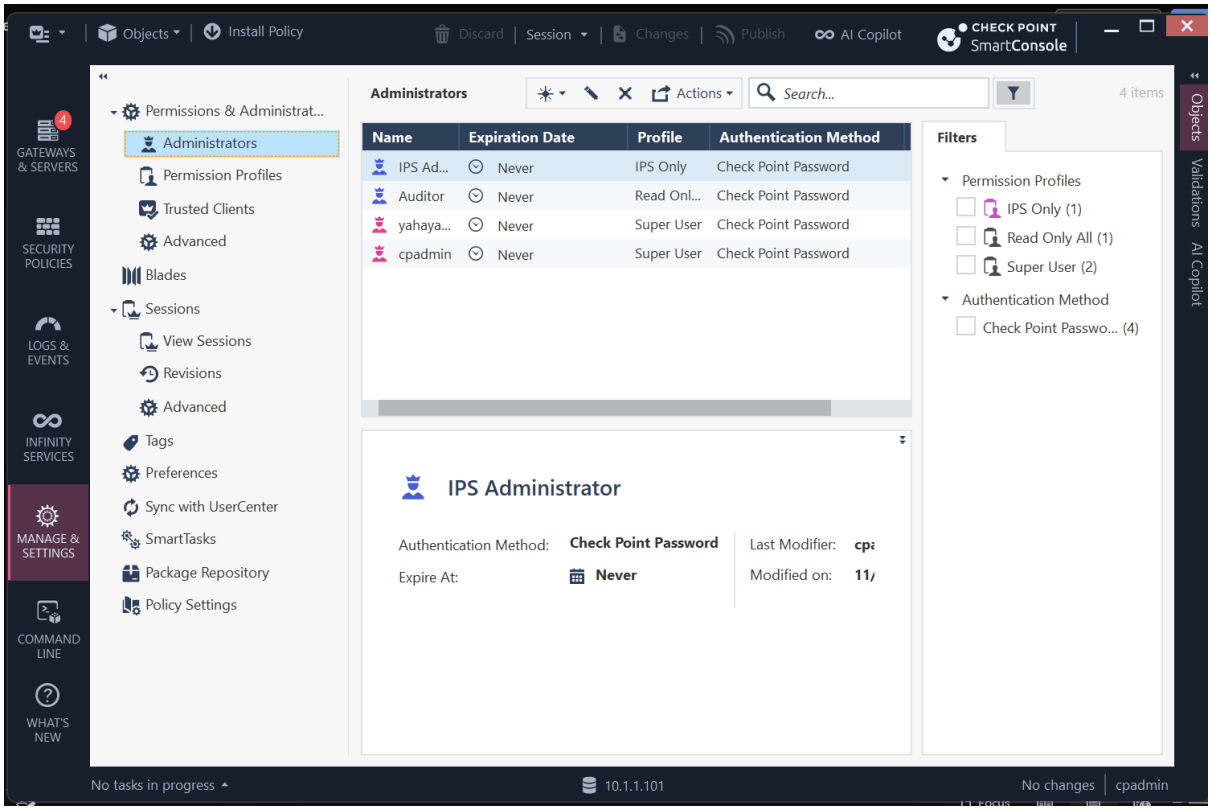
Actions Performed

- Published the management session.
- Session Name: Added New Administrators and Permissions Profile
- Performed Install Database.
- Selected:
  - A-SMS
  - A-SME

Observation
The database installation completed successfully on A-SMS but failed on A-SME because it is not powered on.

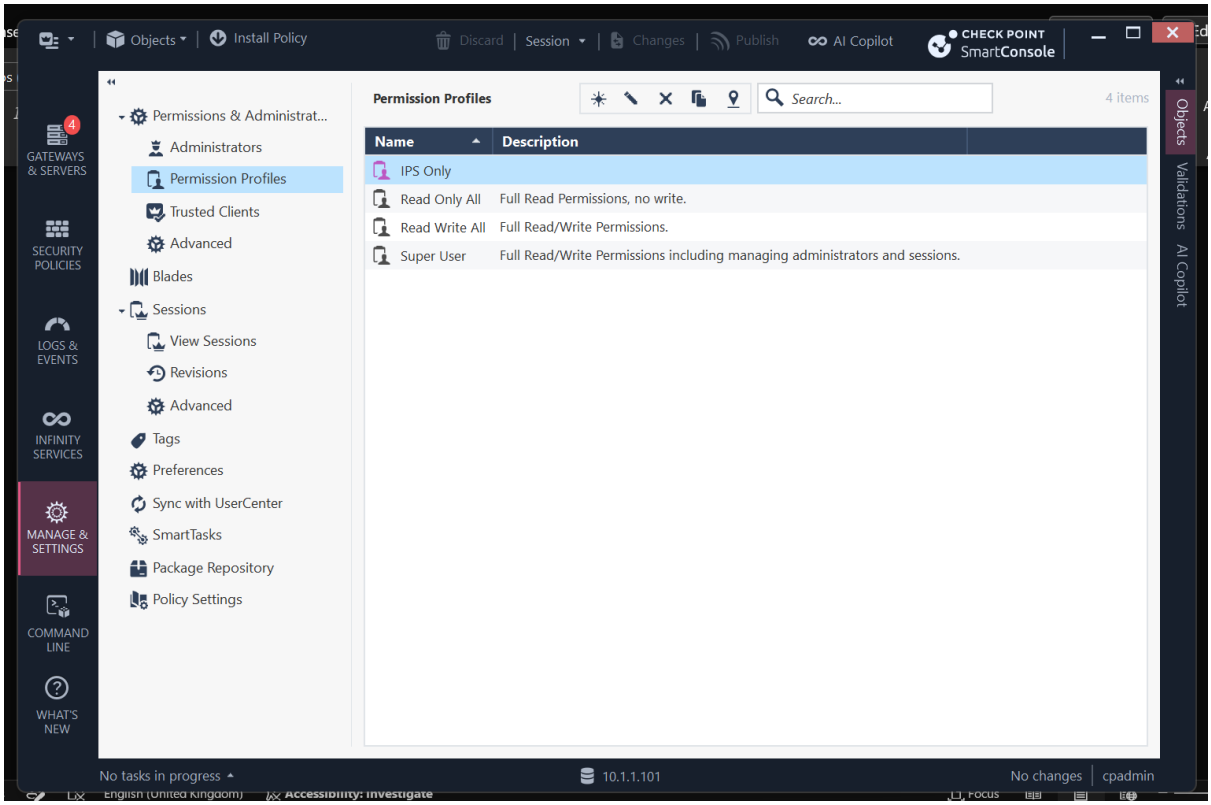
Part 2: Evidence

Evidence A: Administrator Accounts



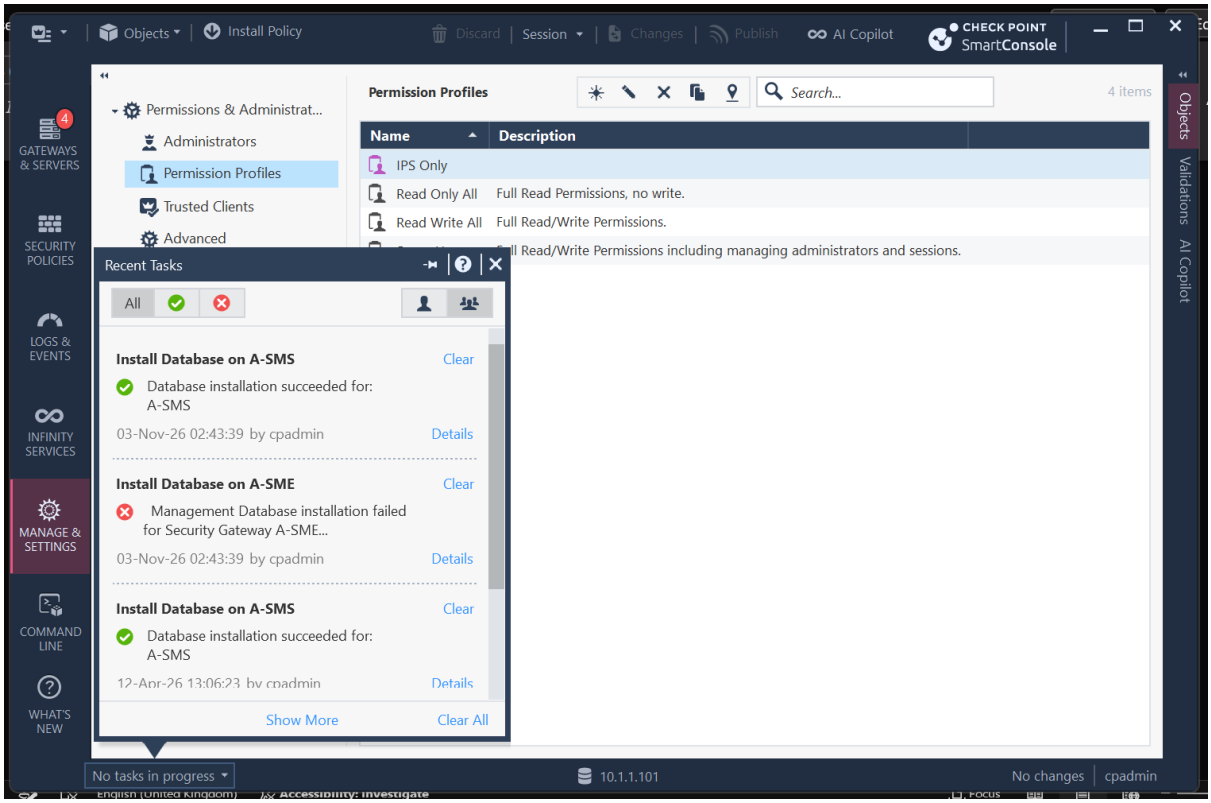
The Administrators list contains cpadmin, the personal administrator account(Yahaya_nasir), Auditor, and IPS Administrator.

Evidence B: Permission Profiles



The custom IPS Only permission profile was successfully created and appears in the Permission Profiles list.

Evidence C: Install Database Success



The Install Database task completed successfully on A-SMS but failed on A-SME as shown in the Recent Tasks window.

Part 3: Short-Answer Questions

1. Explain the difference between a Check Point Password and an OS Password authentication method.

A Check Point Password is stored and managed within the Check Point Security Management Server and is used specifically for SmartConsole authentication. An OS Password authenticates users against the operating system account database of the management server.

2. What is the main difference between the default Super User and Read Only All permission profiles?

The Super User profile provides full administrative access to create, modify, publish, and install policies. The Read Only All profile allows users to view configurations and policies but prevents them from making changes.

3. In session management, what happens to your changes if you click Discard versus if you click Publish?

Selecting Discard removes all unpublished changes made during the current session.

Selecting Publish saves the changes to the management database and makes them available to other administrators.

4. According to best practices, why should you limit the use of Super User accounts and apply the principle of least privilege?

Super User accounts have unrestricted access and can make significant changes to the security environment. Applying the principle of least privilege reduces security risks by giving administrators only the permissions required for their specific job.

Conclusion

This lab demonstrated how to manage administrator accounts, create permission profiles, assign role-based permissions, publish management changes, and install the database in a Check Point R82 Security Management environment.